Five Days to Go/No-Go

Thursday 27 August 2026 · To: David Qu, TJ Falohun, Qiping Fan · From: Logan DuBose

Three discussions today moved the proposal further than the previous week did. **The application can plausibly reach a fundable range,** and the work that gets it there is now specific rather than vague. We sprint to Tuesday 1 September, then decide honestly whether to submit on the 4th.

The problem now has four gates: find it · afford it · execute it · staff it

Qiping identified the gap. The work between finding care and receiving it is administrative, which is exactly what the agent layer does, and we were not naming it. Propagates to Figure 1, the opening Significance sentence, and the competitive table.

From David's written feedback

POSITIONING We are a platform company, not a staffing or advertising company, and we make money when value is delivered to the provider. Revenue in tiers: providers now, payers later. Beef up the premium provider offering and its value proposition. Emphasize our data and AI capability, and that we are outcome-driven rather than transaction-driven, with the whole ecosystem benefiting.

CRAFT One bold north star tying the aims and innovations together (TJ + Logan). Structure the content for ease of reading. Audit every figure and every citation. Fuller bios, named advisors and prospective investors (Logan). Full grammar and typo pass. Formatting conventions to confirm against NIH assembly rules.

DECIDED TODAY

- **Staffing is the beachhead, for two reasons.** It is the only thing we can sell now, and it is the bottleneck that makes navigation fail.
- **The payer opportunity is an important secondary endpoint.** Outcomes data payers care about, collected alongside the other work throughout the aims, is the deliverable that gives a payer the confidence to strike a navigation contract with us. The concern is working it into the prose without overwhelming it.
- **Aim 3 gets simpler.** One price, one wave, no human subjects. The four-price randomized design is dropped: providers talk to each other, so varying price is a commercial risk, not just a statistical one.
- **Market selection becomes criteria-driven,** including payer consolidation, per David's account of Times Square Health choosing Rochester over Chicago.
- **No campus stratification.** We have no hypothesis that students outperform other workers, so it tests nothing.
- **Students are not the innovation.** The system that brings new capacity into a local market through licensed providers is. Students are the first population tested.
- **Aim 2 measures value created,** and willingness to pay becomes the explicit output that sets the Aim 3 price. Provider question sharpened to: did you have to deny care to anyone we sent you?
- **National baselines, not a control arm,** for readmission and admission comparison.
- **Qiping moves to co-PI.** Effort unchanged.
- **Commercialization Plan gets rebuilt from a clean sheet.** Of 24 substantive claims in it, 19 already appear in the Research Strategy and none are unique to it.

STILL OPEN

- **How many paid markets?** 8 down to 4 or 6, one wave. Drives the model, budget, and feasibility critique. *Logan + Qiping*
- **What does one mature market earn?** Four figures exist across our own documents, $30k to $165k. Nothing commercial can be written until this is one number. *Logan, today*
- **Are workers in the Aim 1 usability study?** Removed, then proposed back. *Qiping*
- **Aim 2 or Aim 3 for care establishment?** *Qiping*

WHO IS DOING WHAT

TJ	Innovation, Aim 1, and the north star framing, then a whole-document read for holes rather than sentences. Innovation has gone from our weakest section to possibly our strongest.
Qiping	Approach and human-subjects rigor. Rebuild Aim 3 to read more simply than Aims 1 and 2. National-baseline literature search. Map David's outcome list onto secondary measures. Flag absolutes.
Logan	Commercialization Plan clean-sheet rebuild, next 24 hours, revenue number first. Bios, advisors, letters, budget daily. Hands off the Research Strategy for 24 hours.
David	Commercial pressure testing. Outcome list delivered and in use. Reviews the Tuesday package. Investor letter on outcome, economic value, replicability.
Marcia	Independent read of the Tuesday package.

THE NEXT FIVE DAYS

Thu to Sun	Each of us on our own section, async check-in at 24 to 36 hours, then the heaviest writing window: substantiation sweep, commercialization modelling and figures, letters chased.
Monday	Integration. Three documents as one argument: same market count, price, revenue figure, vocabulary.
Tue to Fri	Package circulated Tuesday morning, go/no-go that evening. If go, Wednesday to Friday for submission.

Roughly 120 hours of calendar time remain before go/no-go. Near 120 to 150 focused hours across the three of us tells us whether this reaches a fundable range. An ambitious target, not a quota.

TUESDAY, ONE QUESTION

Is this application strong enough that submitting on 4 September is justified, or would several more months materially improve its probability of funding? Decided on quality, not hours spent.

GO
Plausibly fundable. Wed to Fri: integration, pressure testing, polish, submission.

POSTPONE
More development improves the odds. Nothing wasted: a stronger application and a plan toward January.